SPORTS NCAA: Colorado upsets UNLV • Saint Mary's vs. Purdue, 4:15 p.m. Friday, truTV

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TRAGEDY IN GILROY

Iraq vet snaps, kills girl, 11

Man turns gun on little sister, then self; police believe missing mother also shot

By Julia Prodis Sulek, Lisa Fernandez, Joe Rodriguez and Bruce Newman
Staff writers

A 27-year-old Iraq War veteran who suffered from post-traumatic stress disorder killed his 11-year-old sister, before fatally turning a gun on himself, according to Gilroy police, who also feared he may have also killed or seriously wounded their mother.

"It's horrible," said Gilroy police Sgt. Chad Gallacinao. "We have no idea where the mom is."

Gilroy police said they rushed to the Redwood Apartments complex on Kern Avenue on Wednesday night after a report that something there might be wrong. When officers arrived, they found the 11-year-old girl — Lucero — dead, with a bullet in her head. They also found the body of her older brother, Abel Gutierrez, who had served with the U.S. Army in Iraq. Police said he may have shot their mother, Martha Gutierrez, 52, before turning the gun on himself.

In the weeks leading up to the violence, neighbors and relatives at the complex reported that Abel Gutierrez was known there for his often troubling, frightening and aberrant behavior toward family and strangers. However, on an emergency call to the family residence Feb. 29, police determined the young military veteran did not seem dangerous.

On Thursday, in Gilroy, a police spokesman said, "There was forensic evidence at the scene to suggest that Martha Gutierrez is critically injured

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NHAT V. MEYER/STAFF

Mourners set up a memorial Thursday for Lucero Gutierrez, an 11-year-old slain by her brother, Abel Gutierrez, in a murder-suicide in Gilroy.

Martha Gutierrez
Missing mother of 27-year-old shooter is believed injured or deceased.

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DAIRY DEBATE

Not cowed by risks

Despite report warning of bacteria and illness from raw milk, enthusiasts swear by health benefits of unpasteurized product

KAREN T. BORCHERS/STAFF PHOTOS

Mark McAfee, founder of Organic Pastures Dairy, has 430 cows on 500 acres near Fresno. The business, which he says serves about 75,000 consumers every week, is one of only two state-licensed raw milk dairy operations.

By Helen Shen
hshen@mercurynews.com

Sujatha Kattimani, a Redwood City software engineer, drives regularly to the Cupertino farmers market to buy raw milk at $7.25 per half-gallon. It's about three times as expensive as regular milk and, according to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, could make her ill. Kattimani drinks two glasses a day anyway. And she's one of a rapidly growing number of raw milk enthusiasts.

Raw milk has not been pasteurized, or heated to kill bacteria. A recent CDC study said raw milk products accounted for 36 percent of individuals sickened in milk-related disease outbreaks from 1993 to 2006. That's a large percentage considering that only an estimated 1 percent of milk drinkers consume raw milk.

In all, 4,413 people were sickened in dairy-borne outbreaks — although that is just a small fraction of the 48 million people the CDC estimates are sickened by food each year.

"No matter how you line it up, there is more risk with the raw product," said Michele Jay-Russell, a UC Davis food safety expert not involved in the study.

CDC epidemiologist Adam Langer, lead author of the study, noted that research does not support any special health benefits of raw milk.

"It's just not worth the risk," he said.

But raw milk's popularity persists in California, fueled by permissive laws that allow it to be sold in supermarkets and an-

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An Organic Pastures Dairy sign at a farmers market booth touts the benefits of raw milk. The milk pasteurization issue pits natural food fans against the repeated warnings issued by government health agencies.

Online: Scan this code with your smartphone or go to photos.mercurynews.com to view a slideshow. Vote in our poll on raw milk at www.mercurynews.com/health.

EDUCATION FUNDING

Fewer teachers in Bay Area pink-slipped

School districts aren't holding off because budgets are better but because there isn't much left to cut

By Sharon Noguchi and Theresa Harrington
Staff writers

For five years, California teachers have dreaded March 15, the deadline for schools to issue layoff warnings. But in the Bay Area, fewer pink slips were sent out this year than anticipated — not because school budgets are better, but because there aren't many places left to cut.

Oakland Unified, which handed out hundreds last year, issued zero, as did Lafayette. San Jose Unified notified all its administrators, just as a precaution, but none of its teachers. Fremont Unified did likewise.

Many districts did issue dozens of notices just to keep their options open because they can't lay off teachers unless they've been notified by this week. New Haven in Union City sent out pink slips for 77 full-time-equivalent jobs. Mount Diablo in Contra Costa County sent out 91; Antioch

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ONLINE: For more education news, go to www.mercurynews.com/education.

PROFESSORS' CONDEMNATION

UC Berkeley faculty demand firing in pay-raise scandal

Administrator who tripled lover's salary reassigned, gets salary pared to $175,000

By Matt Krupnick
mkrupnick@bayarenanewsgroup.com

BERKELEY — A growing chorus of voices is calling for the firing of a UC Berkeley administrator who helped triple her secret sex partner's pay over five years.

Calling Diane Leite's punishment "an affront" to the university, several UC Berkeley professors have asked the school's provost to investigate how the matter was handled. They are aghast that, instead of firing her, the university reassigned Leite from her assistant vice chancellor post and will still pay her $175,000 a year.

"It's an outrage," said engineering professor

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Online: Read the letter from UC professors at www.mercurynews.com/extra

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Stephen Jackson is on his way to the Spurs

BUSINESS » B6

Home sales up, prices dip in most of Bay Area

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